CAREER

How to Go From ₹4 LPA to ₹15 LPA as a Data Analyst

The exact path: what changes between a ₹4 LPA and a ₹15 LPA role, the skills to build, the projects to show, where to apply and how to negotiate.

INSIDE THIS PDF · 8 PAGES

- **What actually changes**
- **The skill stack for ₹15 LPA**
- **The 3-phase plan**
- **2 projects that signal ₹15 LPA**
- **Where to apply**
- **Negotiating the offer**
- **Your checklist**

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What actually changes

The jump is not about knowing more tools. It is about owning bigger problems.

- **At ₹4 LPA**

  You pull data someone asked for, update the same report every week, and fix Excel errors.

- **At ₹15 LPA**

  You decide which numbers matter, build the dashboard the business runs on, and explain why a metric moved.

- **The shift**

  From "I made the report" to "I found why revenue dropped 8% in the South and the team fixed it".

Honest timeline: most people make this jump in 2 to 3 years, often across 2 job switches. One switch from ₹4 to ₹15 LPA happens, but it is rare.

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The skill stack for ₹15 LPA

This is what interviewers at that level test. Rate yourself on each.

- **SQL: advanced**
  Window functions, CTEs, query performance, reading other people's SQL.
- **One BI tool, deeply**
  Power BI or Tableau with a proper data model, not just charts.
- **Python for analysis**
  Pandas for cleaning and analysis that Excel cannot handle.
- **Statistics you can apply**
  A/B tests, confidence intervals, when a change is real or noise.
- **Business metrics**
  Revenue, retention, CAC, conversion funnel for your domain.
- **Communication**
  A one-page summary with a recommendation, not a 20-tab workbook.

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The 3-phase plan

Run this alongside your current job. 1 to 1.5 hours a day.

- **Months 1-4: fill the skill gaps**

  Pick the 2 weakest skills from the last page. Practise on real datasets, not tutorials.

- **Months 5-8: create proof**

  Build 2 portfolio projects (next page). Apply one new skill at your current job and measure the result.

- **Months 9-12: switch**

  Update resume and LinkedIn, get referrals, interview for ₹8-12 LPA roles at better companies.

- **Year 2: repeat**

  Own a business area in the new role, then target ₹15 LPA+ with real impact to show.

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2 projects that signal ₹15 LPA

Recruiters skip Titanic and Netflix datasets. These show business thinking.

1. Revenue or churn deep dive

Real e-commerce or telecom data. Find the 3 biggest drivers of churn or revenue drop, size each in ₹, recommend actions.

2. End-to-end KPI dashboard

Raw data → SQL transformations → star schema → Power BI. Include a one-page written insight summary.

What makes them stand out

A clear business question, numbers in ₹ or %, and a README a manager can read in 2 minutes.

Best proof of all: one result from your current job, like "automated the weekly MIS, saving 6 hours a week". Put it at the top of your resume.

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Where to apply

The same skills pay very differently depending on the company type.

- **Product companies**

  Fintech, e-commerce, SaaS. Analysts work closely with product and growth teams.

- **GCCs (global capability centres)**

  Banks, retailers and tech firms with India centres often pay well for analytics.

- **Analytics-first consultancies**

  Good for the first switch to build domain depth fast.

- **How to get in**

  Referrals first. Message people in the team with one specific line about their product and your project.

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Negotiating the offer

Most people leave money on the table by naming a number too early.

- **Do not share current CTC first**

  Say: "I am looking for a role in the range the market pays for this skill set. What is the budget for this position?"

- **Anchor on the role, not your old salary**

  Your current pay reflects your old role. The offer should reflect the new one.

- **Have a second offer if you can**

  Two offers is the strongest negotiation tool there is.

- **Negotiate the full package**

  Fixed pay, joining bonus, variable, notice-period buyout, learning budget.

Script: "I am excited about this role. Based on the scope and my other conversations, I was expecting closer to ₹X. Is there flexibility on the fixed component?"

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Your checklist

Tick these off in order.

- [ ] **Score yourself on the 6 skills**
  Pick the 2 weakest to work on first.
- [ ] **Build 2 business projects**
  With ₹ impact and a short README.
- [ ] **Get 1 measurable win at work**
  Time saved, money saved, a decision changed.
- [ ] **Rewrite your resume**
  Every line: action + tool + result in numbers.
- [ ] **Apply through referrals**
  Target product companies and GCCs.
- [ ] **Negotiate on role, not old CTC**
  Use the script on the last page.

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